

Teaching Evaluations

PSY 317 Social Psychology Laboratory

Evaluation overview

Term	Format	Enrollment	Evaluations	Response rate	Overall instructor	Overall course
Fall 2024	Fully in person	32	28	87.5%	3.93	2.96
Summer 2025	Online asynchronous	5	2	40.0%	4.50	5.00
Summer 2026	Online asynchronous	20	16	80.0%	4.25	4.06

Across PSY 317 offerings, students rated instructor knowledge, preparation, feedback, and support for critical thinking positively. Fall 2024 evaluations also identified workload as a major concern relative to the two-credit course structure. Later online offerings received stronger course-level ratings and positive comments regarding organization, pacing, scaffolding, and feedback.

Fall 2024

Two fully in-person sections. LO1: 16 enrolled, 14 respondents. LO2: 16 enrolled, 14 respondents. Combined: 32 enrolled, 28 respondents (87.5% response rate).

Combined quantitative results

Scale: 1 = strongly disagree; 5 = strongly agree. Positive combines Agree and Strongly agree; negative combines Disagree and Strongly disagree.

Evaluation item	LO1 mean	LO2 mean	Combined mean	Positive	Neutral	Negative
The instructor was knowledgeable about the subject.	4.57	4.79	4.68	96.4%	3.6%	0.0%
The instructor was enthusiastic about the course.	4.21	4.00	4.11	82.1%	10.7%	7.1%
The instructor was prepared for class sessions.	4.64	4.79	4.71	100.0%	0.0%	0.0%
The workload for this course was reasonable and manageable.	2.14	2.57	2.36	14.3%	28.6%	57.1%
The course encouraged critical thinking and application of concepts.	4.14	4.21	4.18	85.7%	7.1%	7.1%
Overall, I would rate the instructor as good.	3.93	3.93	3.93	71.4%	14.3%	14.3%
Overall, I would rate the course as good.	2.64	3.29	2.96	39.3%	21.4%	39.3%

Section-level response distributions

Counts are shown for all 14 respondents in each section.

Section and item	SA	A	N	D	SD	Mean	Positive
LO1 The instructor was knowledgeable about the subject.	9	4	1	0	0	4.57	92.9%
LO1 The instructor was enthusiastic about the course.	4	9	1	0	0	4.21	92.9%
LO1 The instructor was prepared for class sessions.	9	5	0	0	0	4.64	100.0%
LO1 The workload for this course was reasonable and manageable.	0	2	3	4	5	2.14	14.3%
LO1 The course encouraged critical thinking and application of concepts.	6	5	2	1	0	4.14	78.6%
LO1 Overall, I would rate the instructor as good.	4	7	1	2	0	3.93	78.6%
LO1 Overall, I would rate the course as good.	1	2	3	7	1	2.64	21.4%
LO2 The instructor was knowledgeable about the subject.	11	3	0	0	0	4.79	100.0%
LO2 The instructor was enthusiastic about the course.	6	4	2	2	0	4.00	71.4%
LO2 The instructor was prepared for class sessions.	11	3	0	0	0	4.79	100.0%
LO2 The workload for this course was reasonable and manageable.	1	1	5	5	2	2.57	14.3%
LO2 The course encouraged critical thinking and application of concepts.	6	7	0	0	1	4.21	92.9%
LO2 Overall, I would rate the instructor as good.	6	3	3	2	0	3.93	64.3%
LO2 Overall, I would rate the course as good.	0	8	3	2	1	3.29	57.1%

Fall 2024 - Section L01

Anonymous Written Responses

Student contribution

I liked the group discussions and being able to talk with classmates

Participation

I feel that I excelled on the midterm paper

I feel as though I excelled in the group work. It was very fun working with a group and I feel as though I am very good at collaborating.

I feel like I positively contributed to group discussions. I tried to come to every class prepared and offer my insights and thoughts for all questions posed by the instructor. In addition to that, I also feel like I was honest with my group members and the instructor when I didn't understand a concept.

lots of participation

i felt like i engaged in the class discussion a fair amount, i also feel like i participated really well in the group projects. i also participated in the small group discussions.

I don't have any positive commentary, I hated this class.

I thought I contributed insightful and meaningful information to discussions and was engaged during class time.

Group discussions

My critical thinking through this course contributed exponentially. In other courses, I typically remain silent or keep these skills to myself. However, in this class, I was able to voice my thoughts and opinions, which helped me gain skills and obtain information that were applicable to other classes.

I really enjoyed and felt competent during the group work and presentation portion particularly. Once I understood the objective of the assignment, I felt like I was knowledgeable and could present with confidence.

I feel like I knew a little bit of research methods before this course, which I really enjoyed sharing during class. I think I shared a few interesting insights.

Self-identified improvement

Read more of the prompts in depth

Nothing, I feel that I participated efficiently

I think I could have improved on my first essay. I also think I could have improved my attendance earlier in the semester.

I think I could improve my time management for class. There were times when I was reading the articles the day of class, not allowing me to fully comprehend the material. If I allocated more time, then I could have come more prepared.

maybe reading more of the readings before class

i think i couldve spoken up even more in class discussions.

I felt I participated enough

I think I could have asked more questions.

Paying attention

At the beginning of the semester, my participation and performance were met to expectations. However, later in the semester, these expectations decreased and I had to overcompensate on assignments and group projects during this time as I was not present in class a few times.

At times I did not feel as though the lab connected to the Social Psychology lecture and made it hard to understand what was being asked. It is also true that I took the lecture about 2 semesters ago...

I could have participated more during class, but I feel like I did good overall

Instructor strengths

Slides were informative

She would take time to re-explain topics that students were confused on

Knowing the material

The instructor was extremely smart and was able to guide us towards the answers.

A strength of the course was the group discussions. This allowed us to hear a different way of explaining concepts. This was something that could further a student's comprehension and clarify any lingering questions.

very knowledgeable and kind and pushes you to think

she responded to emails pretty quickly. she also seemed like she enjoyed talking about research, which is what this class was about (not social psych) and was knowledgeable about topics and terms related to research.

Strength was that instructor is knowledgeable about course material

The instructor was knowledgeable about the course material

Seems passionate about the topics

Skylar is extremely knowledgeable on topics in social psychology and pushed students to think critically and work together from a social psychologist point of view.

Skylar had a great understanding of the content and on research expectations.

Skylar is very knowledgeable about the content particularly research methods and ethical concerns. She was very helpful when I had questions about content or when doing assignments. She was also very understanding when I got sick at the beginning of the semester. I liked how small the class was and the discussion focused approach as I felt quite comfortable when I did my final presentation - and public speaking usually makes me feel very anxious.

Skylar made the class very engaging, which I deeply enjoyed. Her slides were interactive and I really enjoyed the activities throughout. The content was also presented in a way that made sense. She always knew how to explain the concepts and topic in a way that was clear and effective.

Instructor/course improvements and other comments

Little more explanation in different ways sometimes I did not understand the wording

The last two large assignments should be spaced out more

The class content was not relatable to the lecture

Lectures were so long and disengaging, other exact same 317 lab classes who met once a week out got let out early and didn't do discussion notebooks. I felt they were irrelevant.

I felt like the coursework was too much for a 2 credit class. This included discussion notes books, finals project and presentations along with a methods paper, I think one or the other is fine but both as a lot.

Sometimes it felt like the instructor was so smart that there was a disconnect between her and the students because most of us do not know much about statistics or research.

An area of improvement could be the amount of outside work allocated. Some of the pair's readings were, in my opinion, extremely long, which made it hard to fully read when paired with other courses' work. If there were fewer assigned, it could increase the chances that students actually read the assigned pieces.

changing the course format and focus more on social psychology rather than research design

i liked the course but really found it hard to fully engage since it seemed like another research design class. i was looking forward to more experiments and topics related more closely to social psychology and not the general field

she seemed to get impatient and got annoyed by people asking clarifying questions. there was a disproportionate amount of readings for the amount of credits of the class. we would do the readings before the class lecture, essentially teaching ourselves.

I felt like the course work was way too much for this class. Expectations were too high regarding what we needed to read and do for class preparation. Way too much coursework

I think that the amount of assignments and the difficulty of work needs to be reconsidered for this course. I did not feel like the amount of work given in this class was equal to a 2 credit course. I did more work for this class than I did for my normal 3 credit courses. I did not like that this course was so research heavy, I feel like very little of what we learned was ever tied back to social psychology and mainly focused on research design.

3 participation and discussion notebooks dropped to account for absences.

This course was a lot more rigorous than I expected it to be, but I gained a lot of skills and knowledge in psychology as a whole. As most labs end early after all material is completed, Skylar took up the whole 100 minutes of class, but it was all worth it in the end as all content was relevant to our group projects.

This class was beneficial, I was just overwhelmed with the OSF preregistration, presentation, and paper. I think that limiting those assignments to two would be more manageable, but overall, it wasn't as daunting as it was originally!

I think Skylar greatly understood the course and she tried to reflect that in her teaching; however, I think sometimes her expectations were high and at times made it difficult to fully connect to the content.

For a lab I found the workload to be a bit excessive. We had quite a few readings per week, two papers and two presentations. Out of all my classes this semester (including the other lab I was taking, a 300 and 400 level psych class) this was the one I was struggling the most with work. I also wish that we had focused more on social psychology and used studies within this field to relate to the content of QMPs and such.

I feel like everything went really well. I do think we could have started the final paper project a week earlier, so that the final paper was due before finals week to make it easier and less stressful.

Fall 2024 - Section L02

Anonymous Written Responses

Student contribution

participation

I participated in class and engaged with the content and my classmates.

small group discussions

I feel like I did well with organizing times with my groups to get stuff done. I excelled in the readings we needed to have each week for discussion.

Time management, group organization, writing

Attendance journals

Group work

group project, small group discussions

Coming to class with prerequisite knowledge from other classes.

I feel like I really stepped up and applied myself and was very engaged in during the class as well as for assignments.

Excelled at participating in group discussions

I did the vast majority of the readings on time and actively participated in discussions and answering questions.

I think that the in-class discussion we had were very valuable.

Applying my knowledge of statistics and pervious research experience, and my contributions to group projects

Self-identified improvement

not sure

None, I did the best I could in this course.

big group discussions

Being a little more prepared for the presentations. I knew all the information, but as soon as I was up there I froze and felt like I had little confidence in my ability to answer questions

I do feel like this was a lot of work for 2 credits but I learned so much

It was very discouraging considering how rude she was

Talking in class

talking more in the big group discussions

Nothing comes to mind.

Communicating with my teacher in advance when life effects my performance in class. I could also ask for help more often,

Could have turned some assignments in on time

N/A, I did my very best.

I think I could have improved on asking questions.

My willingness to engage in classroom discussion

Instructor strengths

she seemed to know what she was talking about

Very knowledgeable and passionate about the topic.

very knowledgeable and has a great understanding of research

Some strengths I would say the instructor had was her knowledge on the topic of research.

Engaging and clear

She knew a lot about study designs- not much social psychology

Very smart on this course! She knew everything plus more.

has a very good understanding of research

She made sure that everyone was contributing fairly to each team's overall effort.

I thought Skylar was very attentive to the class and was always willing to help and answer questions.

Very knowledgeable and made us think for ourselves

Ms Yu was very knowledgeable, incorporated videos or activities(DNs) into her lectures which made them more engaging and made us be more reflective about the material. She always prepared and good at answering the class's questions. Reasonable late work policy.

I think the the instructor was always facilitating critical thinking and could answer any questions we had.

Was very knowledgable on course content, and held the class to high expectations. Helped explain concepts clearly and thoroughly.

Instructor/course improvements and other comments

it seems like she forgot that this lab is only worth 2 credits- it was treated as a 4 credit lab. course load seemed unreasonable.

Managing the course could improve and feedback could be more constructive and professional.

As this course is a 2 level credit class, it should be more manageable for students and less stressful.

having the class be more engaged, maybe do small exercises or actives in class

I think feedback is a great tool to better yourself, however the feedback from the instructor came across as passive aggressive and a bit rude. It just felt like every time we had a question she seemed to think we were just plain stupid.

N/A

Understanding workload in comparison to course level and credit hour. I've never had more work out of all my classes and it was less credits

No

lower expectations of students

whole lot of work for 2 credits, i didn't like the class that much, but the teacher was great!

could make the class more engaged with more activities

This course is very reading-heavy and hard to keep up with when juggling more than one class. Assigning 30+ pages to read on Monday and wanting it done for conversations on Wednesday is a lot to ask students in a 2 credit class. I think this class should be upgraded to 3 credits because of the amount of work being asked.

For the final presentations, I would've preferred to to receive constructive feedback on the presentations and what didn't work in them at the end of class versus while we are standing at the front of the room.

Overall, you are a great teacher and incredibly smart (it is very intimidating at times haha). Thank you for a good semester and pushing us to be better.

N/a

Thank you for a great semester!

There were too many readings. Usually multiple long readings were assigned to us each week. It was incredibly difficult to keep up with all the work, readings and writings. Especially having to read the Hagger et. al readings multiple times to do a presentation(that we didn't get points for). This class should be 3 credits as it was as much work as my regular lecture classes, if not more.

I think we could have more time to work on large assignments in class.

Could be blunt in feedback delivery at times, and course load felt like that of a 3 credit class at times.

Overall enjoyed the class and the teaching style!

Summer 2025

Online asynchronous. Enrollment: 5. Respondents: 2 (40.0% response rate). The small response count should be considered when interpreting these results.

Complete quantitative results

Scale: 1 = strongly disagree; 5 = strongly agree.

Evaluation item	SA	A	N	D	SD	N	Mean	Positive
Instructor knowledgeable about the subject	2	0	0	0	0	2	5.00	100.0%
Instructor enthusiastic about the course	2	0	0	0	0	2	5.00	100.0%
Assignment instructions and rubrics are clear	1	1	0	0	0	2	4.50	100.0%
Instructor feedback has been helpful	1	1	0	0	0	2	4.50	100.0%
Overall, instructor is good	1	1	0	0	0	2	4.50	100.0%
Overall, course is good	2	0	0	0	0	2	5.00	100.0%

Anonymous Written Responses

Improvement response

N/A

Overall a good summer class. I enjoyed the group work but sometimes it was hard to manage due to it being over summer. There is not anything in specific that stands out for me.

Continue response

The amount of assignments and pace were good, especially for a summer class. It was easy to get in touch with Skylar, which was super nice.
Structure of the class was very clear. I knew when everything was due and where everything was. I enjoyed how much it challenged research. This class gave me a new awareness about research and how it is manipulated at large.

Summer 2026

Online asynchronous. Enrollment: 20. Respondents: 16 (80.0% response rate).

Complete quantitative results

Scale: 1 = strongly disagree; 5 = strongly agree.

Evaluation item	SD	D	N	A	SA	Mean	Positive
The instructor is knowledgeable about the subject.	0	0	0	9	7	4.44	100.0%
The instructor is enthusiastic about the course.	0	1	1	9	5	4.12	87.5%
The assignment instructions and rubrics are clear.	1	2	1	6	6	3.88	75.0%
The feedback from the instructor has been helpful.	0	0	2	8	6	4.25	87.5%
Overall, I would rate the instructor as good.	0	0	2	8	6	4.25	87.5%
Overall, I would rate the course as good.	0	1	0	12	3	4.06	93.8%

Anonymous Written Responses

What should improve?

I think that although I happened to have a positive experience with the group project, it was extremely difficult to coordinate especially for an online, asynchronous class over the summer. In the future I would recommend an alternative project that does not require group work. Overall I enjoyed the course thank you!

The instructor could have exposed the class to more controversial subject matter, such as the violence caused by religious ideology, the hijacking of people's emotions through indoctrination, and institutional gaslighting in more extreme cases of cult ideology. We could also have covered how religious groups use protected status to hide and perpetuate crimes against humanity, in Christianity and Judaism, historically and today.

The only thing that I would improve is the group project. I understand working with our peers, but when you're online and everyone has different schedules, it can be hard to coordinate with everyone. Like maybe there is still a group project, but not as long or just specific to one assignment.

The only issue I came across was coordinating a group presentation time to film. Everyone in my group was very busy, and we struggled to come together at a specific time. I love the idea of the group project; however, the presentation filming portion was a bit difficult to navigate.

Also, I found it quite difficult to discuss data analysis in the project with G power and ttest stat values as that was barely touched on. I was scared turning in my paper because I did not feel confident I did it right...

There were some parts, such as preregistration for the OSF, that lacked explanation. If you are familiar with using OSF, then it would make sense. I have never used it, and neither did my teammates, so trying to figure that out was confusing and could use some more instruction, because we created the study in OSF in the very beginning, but then my team had to create a whole new study in order to do the preregistration thing, so it didn't make a lot of sense. I also felt that doing an individual paper in the middle of a group project didn't make a lot of sense because we had been working together for everything and then suddenly a individual paper was due. I guess it was fine, but it just felt like one more thing to complete randomly when we were in the middle of a group project. Not trying to be mean at all, but I felt like it was tedious. Anyway, thank you guys for taking time out of your summer to hold this course, I'm sure that it wasn't too much fun for you guys haha!

Some of the final project was slightly confusing, so maybe communication on this could improve.

It is hard to assess this in terms of online because I think group projects are significantly more difficult to coordinate online! It was hard because one of our group members never joined, so we all had to do more of the work than other groups.

I think that the feedback could be more specific, such as pinpointing where in an assignment the improvement is needed. Also, the textbook link being on the syllabus was a bit hard to get used to. A dedicated tab may be easier, but that is a preference thing.

I wouldn't ask for any changes.

I think one thing that could be improved is spreading out some of the larger assignments a little more. The replicability project was really helpful, but there were times when multiple pieces were due close together while other classes also had big projects. Breaking a few of those assignments into smaller checkpoints or giving a little more time between them would make the workload feel more manageable.

I would be more detailed in the rubric. I also think group work can be super difficult over the summer with conflicting schedules so I would give a little more grace for that.

I think there needs to be more clear instructions on the OSF and what that all entails. We made an account for it in the first few weeks of the class but then never used it again until the final week of the class. Also the G*force and things like that threw me for a loop as I had never seen anything like this brought up before in the class and the rest of my group was just as confused as I was. It felt like it was thrown in at the end and so I lost points for the paper on something I had never seen before and was very frustrated.

What was done well / should continue?

I liked that feedback and materials were provided often!

The instructor did well at handling a classroom full of students with a diverse set of beliefs and backgrounds and encouraging them to remain amicable while also exploring a controversial subject.

The grading and feedback were very consistent throughout the course, and the materials and course content I found very interesting.

The instructor provided timely, helpful feedback with grades, which is greatly appreciated! I enjoyed the content and the course setup.

Yes, absolutely! It was a good course that could use a little refining around the edges. But don't let that discourage you or make you feel like a bad instructor. It was great, and as much as it could be for an online summer course. So keep on! Thank you again for doing the summer course. I hope your 2026-2027 year is great!

Most of the course was done well.

I think the timeline of the course and the structure of parts of the group assignment with feedback provided was helpful.

Communication was quick and concise. I thought the modules were very organized and it made it easy to navigate.

I loved this course! Especially the final group presentation. If there were more projects like the presentation, I think it would keep the class more engaged.

It is an online course so the instructor did well with what was given. This course was very helpful.

the group project was fun

I like the structure of how the assignments were laid out, it made sense and it made it easier to learn.

I liked how the course built up to the final replicability project instead of having us do it all at once. The smaller assignments and discussions helped me understand each part of the research process before putting everything together. I also appreciated the detailed feedback because it made it easier to improve our project as we went along. Overall, I thought the course was organized well and helped me feel more confident reading and designing research studies.

Clear assignments and structure

She was easy to reach if you had questions about the material. She was also detailed in the actual feedback for the assignments, just not the rubrics themselves.

I think communication was good and the instructor responded quickly to questions that I had.

Evaluation Record

This document contains all currently available anonymous course evaluations for PSY 317 from Fall 2024, Summer 2025, and Summer 2026.